ten or fifteen days. Poor old fellow, I hope he will get his senses again he was always very absent and eccentric.

Tabreez, December 2, 1844

I yesterday received yours of Octr 5th and I cannot tell you the pleasure the news of George's intended marriage gave me. I do not understand why you should take such a melancholy view of an event which ought to give you nothing but pleasure, I should certainly have been better pleased if the lady had possessed some fortune, but as it is I am truly glad to hear that he is about to be married, and as to connections, if she has good commercial connections they will, in all likelihood, be more useful to George than if she was first cousin to the Duke of Devonshire. It is true that I may look upon this, in an Asiatic way. There is a proverb in Persian that "God pays the debts of marriages" the meaning of which is this, that if a man without a sixpence married a lady equally rich, and runs five hundred pounds in debt to buy presents for his wife and expend in fire works and feasting, God is sure to place him in such a position that he soon gains five hundred pounds and pays his debts. And altho I have seen in this country some melancholy instances that this proverb does not always come true, yet I cannot but rejoice at my brother's marriage.

Dr Wolff arrived a week ago from Bokhara and for some days was unwell of a fever, he is now recovered and talks of proceeding on his journey in a few days. One of the most extraordinary things about this strange man is that altho he has passed a great portion of his life in travelling in countries where few dare venture he is one of the most helpless and timorous people I ever met with. He cannot mount a horse without assistance; and when mounted he can not guide him out of a town or village; he is obliged to have a man on foot holding his bridle until he gets in the open country and then the horse follows the others or is driven along by one of the party just as if he had an inanimate load on his back. He appears to be quite incapable of taking care of his money, clothes, or any thing else belonging to him, and is so short sighted that I do not believe he could recognise his own wife across a middle sized room. The other day at the Christening of Mr and Mrs Bonham's son he began making civil speeches to the servant, a woman of about fifty years old in mistake for Mrs Bonham, and it was not until he heard the woman speak that he found out his mistake; you may imagine the laughter of a large party there assembled who saw his mistake from the beginning. He is still in fear that some of the people of the Ameer of Bokhara may way-lay him and murder him on the road; for two nights I slept in his room, chiefly because he was so nervous and melancholy when left alone. He has taken a great fancy to me and talks of trying to get me some place

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